

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-10-09 Friday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply-Demand · Inventory · Commentary

Source SMM / SGX

Futures Contracts		SGX: latest price · DCE: close	
SGX Iron Ore Current-month Contract Latest price		DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily	
90.50 USD/dmt		682.5 yuan/mt	
FEFV26 · 2026-10 · SGX · delayed		— 0 0.00%	
As of preparation: 2026-10-09 18:05:16 (UTC+8)		MTD avg 682.5	
Quote time: 10-09 17:44:04 (UTC+8)		As of Oct 9 · vs Oct 8	

SMM Iron Ore Price Index		Indices as of Oct 9	
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily		MMi 58% Port Spot Daily	
664 yuan/wmt		627 yuan/wmt	
— 0 0.00%		— 0 0.00%	
MTD avg 664		MTD avg 627	

MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily		MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily	
89.20 USD/dmt		109.40 USD/dmt	
▼ -1.15 -1.27%		▼ -0.05 -0.05%	
MTD avg 91.40		MTD avg 110.32	

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily			
821.58 yuan/mt			
▼ -3.22 -0.39%			
MTD avg 823.19			
As of Oct 9 · vs Oct 8			

Key View

Domestic composite prices stabilise while seaborne brands diverge; sustained buying remains key

After reopening, the market is showing stable composite prices alongside divergent brand performance.

DCE most-traded closed at 682.5 yuan/mt, while the 61%, 58% and 65% port indices held at 664, 627 and 828 yuan/wmt. Spot prices did not stabilise uniformly: Mac Fines and BRBF declined, while Carajas Fines and PB Lump recovered. The seaborne 61% index fell further to USD 89.20/dmt while the 65% edged down to 109.40, widening their spread to USD 20.20 and highlighting short-term differences between grades.

Gains in some brands may reflect available supply and blending requirements but do not alone establish a broad recovery in demand. The domestic ore composite index declined to 821.58 yuan/mt, also indicating constraints on mill purchase prices. Freight costs were mixed, with C3 falling and C5 rising. Their implications for miner margins and landed prices depend on contracts, voyage times and exchange rates rather than a uniform move across routes.

A transition from temporary stability to sustained support still depends on mill buying and profitability.

Pressure on finished-steel prices and purchases limited to immediate needs could constrain a rebound amid relatively high shipments. Conversely, margin repair from lower coke costs followed by sustained restocking could improve support. Near-term attention should remain on the persistence of trading and purchasing rather than treating gains in individual brands as a reversal in the overall trend.

Today's Highlights

- ◆ **The seaborne 61% index fell more sharply while the 65% was relatively stable.** On Oct 9, the MMi 61% index was **USD 89.20/dmt**, down USD 1.15 (–1.27%) from Oct 8; the 65% was **109.40**, down USD 0.05 (–0.05%). The grade spread widened from USD 19.10 to 20.20/dmt.
- ◆ **Domestic futures and port indices were unchanged while individual brands diverged.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 682.5 yuan/mt, unchanged from the previous session. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 664, 627 and 828 yuan/wmt. At Qingdao, Mac Fines fell 2 yuan and BRBF fell 5 yuan, while Carajas Fines rose 3 yuan and PB Lump rose 2 yuan.
- ◆ **Seaborne brands showed mixed price movements.** Against Oct 8, PB Fines were USD 89.50/dmt (–1.21%), Newman Fines 88.65 (–1.17%) and Mac Fines 88.85 (–1.39%); Carajas Fines were 105.90 (+0.24%), SSFT/SSFG 96.00 (+0.26%) and Brazilian Blend Fines 96.05 (+0.10%).
- ◆ **The domestic ore composite index eased further.** SMM's Domestic Ore Composite Price Index stood at **821.58 yuan/mt**, down 3.22 yuan (–0.39%) from 824.80 previously. Whether cost relief generates sustained mill buying remains an important indicator of demand recovery.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	10-09 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	650	— 0 0.00%	650	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	653	— 0 0.00%	653	
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	650	▼ -2 -0.31%	651	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	700	▼ -5 -0.71%	702	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	845	— 0 0.00%	845	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	512	— 0 0.00%	512	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	830	▲ +3 +0.36%	828	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	845	▲ +2 +0.24%	844	

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	10-09 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	10-08
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	85.90	▼ -1.10 -1.26%	87.00
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	87.45	▼ -1.25 -1.41%	88.70
PB Fines 62% Daily	89.50	▼ -1.10 -1.21%	90.60
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	88.65	▼ -1.05 -1.17%	89.70
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	88.85	▼ -1.25 -1.39%	90.10
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	84.70	▼ -1.35 -1.57%	86.05
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	105.90	▲ +0.25 +0.24%	105.65
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	96.00	▲ +0.25 +0.26%	95.75
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	96.05	▲ +0.10 +0.10%	95.95
RTX Fines 61% Daily	84.45	▼ -0.85 -1.00%	85.30
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	88.90	▼ -1.20 -1.33%	90.10
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	78.10	▼ -0.35 -0.45%	78.45

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	91.40	-5.29%	-15.8%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	110.32	-3.59%	-9.8%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	664	-4.07%	-18.3%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	828	-1.38%	-7.9%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	627	-3.15%	-12.7%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	823.19	-1.83%	-7.3%	yuan/mt	

On Oct 9, the seaborne 61% index was USD 89.20/dmt (–1.27%) and the 65% was 109.40 (–0.05%), widening their spread from USD 19.10 to 20.20/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices held at 664, 627 and 828 yuan/wmt, unchanged from Oct 8.

* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

Iron Ore Ocean Freight USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarao→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan 	Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly 	Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports 10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports

Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 682.5 yuan/mt, unchanged from Oct 8. Qingdao PB Fines at 650, Newman Fines at 653, Newman Lump at 845 and SSF at 512 yuan/wmt were unchanged. Mac Fines were 650 (–2), BRBF 700 (–5), Carajas Fines 830 (+3) and PB Lump 845 (+2). SGX official delayed data showed current-month FEFV26 at USD 90.50/dmt, timestamped Oct 9, 17:44:04 (UTC+8).
Drivers	Domestic futures and composite port indices stabilised while the seaborne 61% index fell further, showing continued short-term divergence across brands. Gains in some brands did not reverse the weakness and most seaborne quotations and may reflect differences in available material, blending requirements and buying schedules. The composite grade spread widened to USD 20.20/dmt, but a single session is insufficient to establish a sustained shift in mill demand.
Demand	Actual purchasing remains important to assessing price support. The latest available mill survey is dated Sep 30, with daily hot metal output of 2.3882 million mt and a blast furnace operating rate of 88.57%. If finished-steel profitability improves only modestly, mills may continue controlling raw-material stocks and buying to immediate needs. Conversely, margin recovery helped by lower coke costs could improve restocking appetite.
Inventory & supply	Global shipments were 35,9424 million mt and arrivals in China 29,0943 million mt in the week to Oct 2; the latest 10-port stock reading was 103,0165 million mt on Sep 30. High shipments coexist with a short-term decline in arrivals, leaving subsequent inventories dependent on delivery, unloading and mill collection schedules. Price moves in individual brands may reflect localised balances rather than a tightening in aggregate supply.
Cost & margin	Oct 8 freight readings diverged: C3 on the Brazil route was USD 34.44/mt, down 12.83% from 39.51 previously, while C5 on the Australia route rose 8.33% from 13.56 to 14.69. Route-specific freight changes influence landed costs for miners and traders, although the transmission also depends on loading schedules, procurement contracts and exchange rates. The earlier first-round coke cut offers mill cost relief, but stronger demand still depends on finished-steel prices and profitability. SMM's Oct 9 coke briefing also reported that some mills proposed a second-round purchase-price cut of 100 yuan/mt for wet-quenched coke and 110 yuan/mt for dry-quenched coke, scheduled from midnight on Oct 12 rather than already fully effective on Oct 9.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	The Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 821.58 yuan/mt on Oct 9, down 3.22 yuan (–0.39%) from 824.80 on Oct 8. SMM's Tangshan brief reported 66% concentrate at 900–910 yuan/mt on a dry-basis, tax-inclusive ex-works basis, with local prices falling noticeably.
Supply & demand	SMM's Tangshan brief described scarce enquiries, with some transactions fulfilling earlier orders. Low-grade material faced sales difficulties, some sellers offered concessions and mills continued pressing bids lower. Regional resource constraints may support some quotations, but actual purchases and transaction support remain crucial to near-term pricing.
Outlook	Continued weakness in imported ore could feed through to blending costs and increase bargaining pressure on domestic concentrates. Conversely, tighter regional supply and recovering mill purchases may make some markets more resilient. Regional differentiation may persist, with mill margins and trading support remaining key indicators.

Market Factors

Supportive factors

- ◆ DCE and all three composite port indices were unchanged this period.
- ◆ Some port and seaborne brand quotations recovered.
- ◆ The first-round coke cut provides some relief to mill costs.
- ◆ The latest weekly arrivals in China declined WoW.

Bearish factors

- ◆ The seaborne 61% index fell 1.27% to USD 89.20/dmt.
- ◆ Seaborne PB, Newman and Mac Fines quotations declined further.
- ◆ The domestic ore composite index fell 0.39%, reflecting continued procurement pressure.
- ◆ Global shipments remain relatively high, warranting attention to subsequent supply arrivals.

Flash News

- ◆ [Domestic Iron Ore Brief] Iron ore concentrates prices in the Tangshan area are likely to consolidate on a subdued note 2026-10-09
- ◆ [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261009 2026-10-09
- ◆ [SMM Steel] Indian HRC Prices Hold Firm; Maintenance and Full Order Books Raise Supply Concerns 2026-10-09
- ◆ [SMM Steel] India Domestic Steel and Scrap Prices Trend down 2026-10-09
- ◆ [SMM Steel] European HRC: bottoming Buyer Inventories Boost Procurement Expectations, High Cost Support Mill Price Hikes 2026-10-09
- ◆ [SMM Iron Ore] Freight Up 50%, Mills Won't Pay: Brazil's Small Miners Squeezed From Both Ends, So Why Won't Vale Cut? 2026-10-08

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